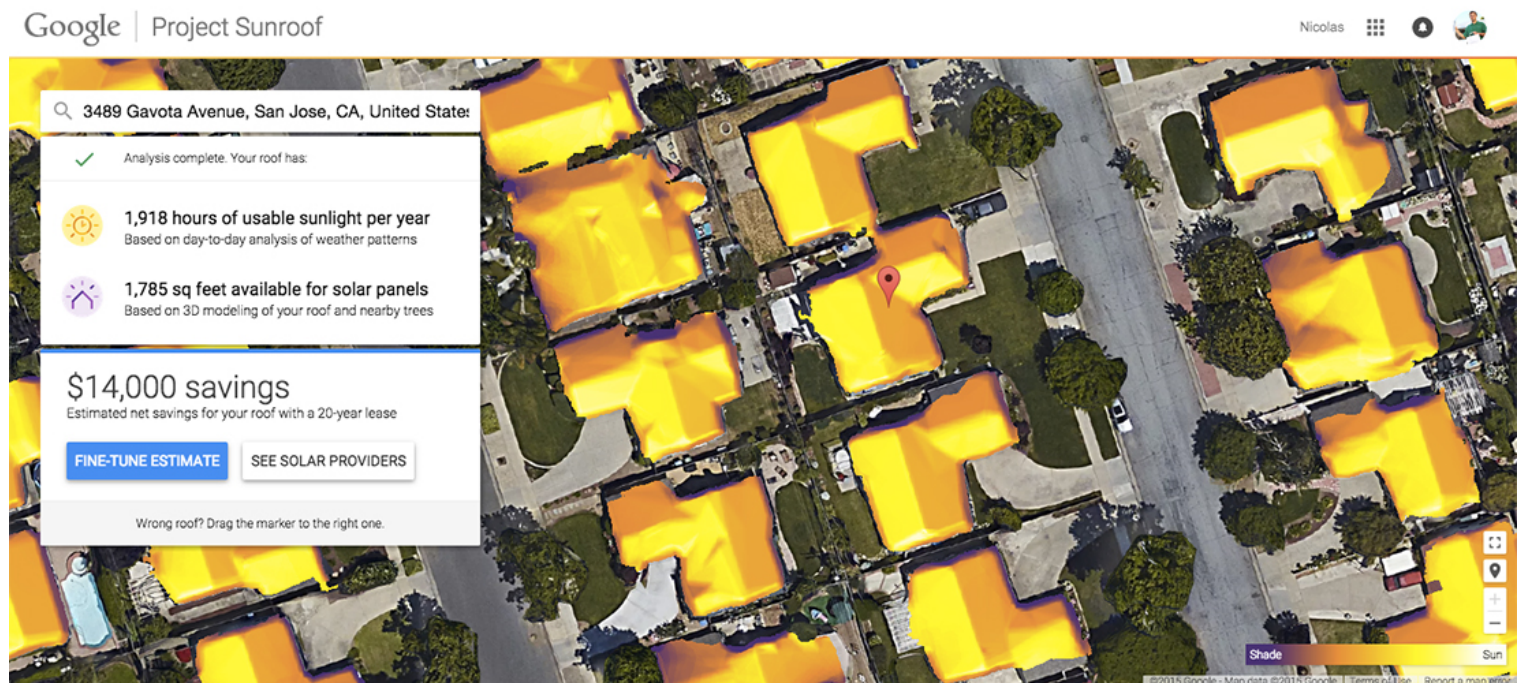


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Blog

Google's Project Sunroof Helps You Decide if Solar Works for You

CHAZ WILKE ([HTTPS://SOLARMEHOME.COM/AUTHOR/CHAZW/](https://solarmehome.com/author/chazw/)) / AUGUST 24, 2015 ([HTTPS://SOLARMEHOME.COM/GOOGLES-PROJECT-SUNROOF-HELPS-YOU-DECIDE-IF-SOLAR-WORKS-FOR-YOU/](https://solarmehome.com/googles-project-sunroof-helps-you-decide-if-solar-works-for-you/)) / [LEAVE A COMMENT \(HTTPS://SOLARMEHOME.COM/GOOGLES-PROJECT-SUNROOF-HELPS-YOU-DECIDE-IF-SOLAR-WORKS-FOR-YOU/#RESPOND\)](https://solarmehome.com/googles-project-sunroof-helps-you-decide-if-solar-works-for-you/#respond)



There are many factors to consider when deciding to install solar panels on the roof of your home. Many of those questions are answered when you decide that you want to save on your electricity bill or generate your own clean energy and become less dependent on fossil fuels. But there is one factor that is solely dependent on your geography. And this is the focus of Google's new Project Sunroof (<http://bit.ly/1NFa62R>).

Google's Project Sunroof

Your candidacy for solar panels on your home and their effectiveness at generating electricity can hinge on where you're located. Google has now released a tool that effectively combines the data from Google Maps with meteorological data to decipher how much sunlight your roof might actually get.

The metrics available to you as you use Google's Project Sunroof include the total hours of usable sunlight per year and the estimated square footage available on your roof for solar panels. These estimates take nearby trees into account and visualize a 3D modeling of your roof.

With that information, Google can present you with actual numbers of how much solar power your home could generate by recommending a number of solar panels to achieve energy independence based on your monthly electricity bill.

Project Sunroof dives into the general cost and savings solar panels would provide based on three options: leasing, loaning or buying your rooftop solar panels. Each search of a specific address includes an estimation of upfront costs after incentives, average annual savings and a grand total 20-year savings breakdown.

If you opt to buy outright, Google's Project Sunroof will show you the amount of years it will take before the initial costs are paid back with savings from generating your own electricity. This is a common question that many have when debating on installing solar panels.

Currently the tool works in Boston, the San Francisco Bay Area and Fresno but plans are in motion to expand the tools reach to the entire nation and then the world!

This might help push those who make decisions based on hard data to take the leap on solar panels.

Introducing Project Sunroof



The Future of Tangential Solar Products

Solar panel production is at an all-time high (<http://bit.ly/1EfB0wm>). And since this industry is exploding in growth, it makes sense that the industry surrounding and supporting solar technologies would grow as well. Google staking its flag in solar technologies is a clear indicator of the field's growth potential.

We are likely to see a continual stream of products and services that are not directly tied to the sales of the solar panels themselves, but meant to be used in conjunction. Google's attempt with Project Sunroof will help many potential solar panel customers discover exactly what they might get out of the deal if they decide to purchase and install their PV panels.



Takeaway

As solar power takes a firm root in the minds of consumers across the world, it seems likely that additional tools and services will spring up to cater to those on the fence about solar panels on their homes. Google's step into this field makes sense and will surely blaze a path for many other tech startups looking to join in on the solar gold rush sweeping across the globe.

Top Image Credit: Google (<http://bit.ly/1NFaspX>)

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